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Ideological Reflections of Swami Vivekananda in Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya: An Exploratory Study

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Abstract : This research paper deals with the educational philosophy of Swami Vivekananda and its reflections on the respective institutions. Researcher has selected Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya, Narendrapur, Kolkata, W.B. for exploring the ideological reflections. It is an effort to analyse the ideology of Swami Vivekananda and investigate that this ideology creates a distinctive environment and regulate functions of the institution. Researcher has prepared a semi structured interview for the administrator/principal/ senior teacher etc. keeping in mind the ideology and institutional activities i.e. academics, co-curricular activities, extra-curricular activities, school and community relationship.

Keywords : Ideological Reflections of Swami Vivekananda, Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya

Introduction : Swami Vivekananda said that education is the panacea of all social evils but by education he did not mean merely book or theoretical learning. He said, 'We must have man-making, life-building, character-making assimilation of ideas.' And added 'What we want is that education by which character is formed, strength of mind is increased, the intellect is expanded and by which one can stand on one's feet.' The Vidyalaya at Narendrapur endeavours to educate the students in its charge according to the best traditions of the country, while instructing them in all directions - physically, mentally, intellectually, and spiritually. It prepares the students for public examination and challenges of life. The Vidyalaya also tries to attend to their all-round growth and development, so that they may become strong and healthy citizens of the country, rooted in sound moral principles, learn to respect the higher values of life and become conscious of their obligations to the society and its people. The chief aim of his education was to develop divine potential already exists in human being, so he named it Man Making Education.

Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya, Narendrapur, Kolkata is completely residential school founded

in the year 1958 on the basis of Swami Vivekananda's Ideology of Man Making and Character Building Education. This school is affiliated to the West Bengal Board of Secondary Education and West Bengal Council of higher Secondary Education. The strength of the school is 875 in all two sections i.e. Junior Section (V-VII) and Senior Section (VIII-XII).

Need and Justification : There have been a lot of studies conducted in order to analyse the educational philosophy of Swami Vivekananda. Bhar, G.(2012) Sarkar, S., Nandi, S., and Ghosh, I. (2012), Tripathi, R., Singh, K.P., and Verma, S. (2015), Agarwal, P. (2016) and Bahera, S.K. (2018) and many more have attempted to investigate the relevance of educational philosophy of Swami Vivekananda and these studies are kind of philosophical inquiry.

This study is an empirical enquiry in which researcher has attempted to investigate the ideological practices of Swami Vivekananda within the educational settings. This study has tried to explore the hidden treasure lies in the ideology devoted deeply to education and institutions built to materialise his dream.

Research Question

1. Does the Ideology of Swami Vivekananda create distinctive atmosphere and regulate functions of Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya?

Objective

1. To Analyse the Ideology of Swami Vivekananda. Operational Definitions of Key Words

Ideological Reflections of Swami Vivekananda: In this research paper, the term ideological reflections means the ideological insights of Swami Vivekananda on the whole educational process i.e. aims of education, means of education etc.

Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya : This term means, Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya, Narendrapur, Kolkata, W.B., which is running under the auspicious Belur Math, Howrah, W.B. Method and Approach of Study

In this study, researcher has used exploratory and descriptive method. All the information and data were analysed by using qualitative approach of research.

Method of Sampling : Researcher has applied purposive method of sampling for the selection of institution.

Tools : Keeping in mind, the research question and objective of this research paper, researcher has prepared semi structured interview. The dimensions of semi structured interview as follows-

- Academics
- Co-Curricular Activities
- Extra Curricular Activities
- School and Community Relationship

Method of Analysis : After collecting the data researcher has transcript and analysed all the responses of Administrator/Teacher/Principal dimensionally against in depth interview.

Data Analysis and Interpretation : Researcher has interacted with the Principal and Senior Lecturer of Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya and researcher has gone through all the responses and analysed thoroughly according to the dimensions and components of the Interview. Researcher has prepared and asked few questions from designates and analysed all the responses.

Academics : In this dimension, researcher has asked few questions from Ideology/Philosophy of the Institution, Meaning, Aims and Vision of the Institution, Pedagogy, Instructional Material/Teaching Learning Material, Personality Development Activities and Value Based Activities for the effective analysis of Ideology of Swami Vivekananda. The detailed analysis of all components is given below.

Ideology/Philosophy of Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya : Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya follows the concept of "Gurugrihwas", in which students go and stay at "Gurugrih" where Character Building and Man Making Education is important. Vidyalaya follows the ideological principles of holy trio Sri Ramkrishna, Sri Ma Sarada Devi and Swami Vivekananda and organize activities accordingly.

The main ideological principles which is followed by the Vidyalaya are-

1. God resides in every human heart
2. Service to mankind is the best worship
3. The real basis of life should be ethics and morality
4. Renunciation and love should permeate the universe

5. Self-realization through self-control

In the light of above mentioned philosophical principles, the Vidyalaya organizes academic and non academic activities for the over all development of the students.

Aims and Vision of Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya : The aim of the institution is to generate perfection of qualities present in students and prepare them for social welfare, 'Be Moral and Do moral' in direction of Man Making. Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya believes that students must be dependent with strong moral values. Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya more emphasised on personal and social welfare. Truth of life to be presented for making life meaningful so that aim of mankind may be fulfil at right time and spiritual development may be materialized. Institute organizes academic and social activities for cultural upgradation and apply different ideas to meet different needs of the society and serve the society.

Pedagogy : There are several curricular activities going on in Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya, some are; Group Discussion, Debate, Extempore, Essay Writing Competition

Apart from these curricular activities, students take part in Music, Recitation, Quiz, Singing, Tabla Playing and Drama etc. throughout the year. In academics six monthly tests, are being taken and many other competitions like quiz based on Swami Ji and on science etc. to help them grow overall.

Instructional Material/Teaching Learning Material : Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya has smart classrooms and audio visual classrooms for class V, VI, VII Standards. Institution has divided the classes into small number of students. In class X there are only 20 - 22 students in each section. They also believe that Teacher is main - Teacher is Knowledge, Presentation, Communication, Expression and Interaction. So if teacher has all the characteristics then teacher can taught without any TLM but of course they played important role in effective teaching learning process. They have also given the importance to real teaching material rather physical apparatus i.e. visit to Zoological Garden, Science City and other important places as the part of TLM.

Personality Development Activities : Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya focuses on overall development i.e. Physical, Mental, Cultural and Spiritual in the same line personality grows. For personality development group leadership is important because leadership programme is very

important for self development. They make every student fit for his own development and it's started from very beginning from Class V. Students are very regular, they maintain the time schedule from 05:00am to 10:00pm.

All the qualities in every student should be expressed for their self and betterment of the society. The highlights for personality development-

- " School perform various activities like morning and evening prayers, regular physical exercises and games every evening.
- " Speech, Extempore Speaking, and some Leadership Programmes are conducted.
- " Every individual grows as per his potential and qualities.
- " They claim to achieve almost everything they expect in personality of an individual

Value Based Activities : Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya believes that every education must be embedded with value added system. In value education while teaching different aspects through text books and other than, text books it must be supported by values. Therefore Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya emphasises on value education for value inculcation among the students. Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya emphasises on in terms of values are-

- " Simple living and high thinking is the value goal
- " Betterment of society and service of mankind is supreme valuable act
- " They are cultivated in various programmes like Sewa Camp, Crisis Management Activities, Helping Others, Self Service and control by Sanyasis impact in other ways like Role Model and this creates an environment of truthfulness and holy atmosphere.
- " Institute organises some activities like campus cleaning, washing and other teamwork activities for promoting value of adaptability, cooperation and tolerance.

The main values which are highlighted by the Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya are; Discipline, Punctuality, Truthfulness, Cleanliness, Self Dependence and these values are inculcated through regular physical exercise, proper timing, regular prayer, cooperation, submissiveness.

Co-Curricular Activities : In Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya, lot of importance is given to the co-curricular activities because these activities are very helpful in strengthening the basic qualities of the students. They help a lot in the development of student's psychology and ideology. These are the way of manifest the inner potential of students.

Exposure to various activities like group activities, extempore, speech, group discussions, essay writing etc. and make balance in spiritual and scientific, physical and mental, individual and social development of students.

Extra-Curricular Activities : Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya gives importance to extra-curricular activities because they believe that these are very important for overall development of students through extra curricular activities related to social, moral and spiritual development. Yoga, Meditation, Short Term Tour and Long Term Tour are organized class wise for real world knowledge. It broadens their mind and heart both. Community services and educational tour is their leisure time are very useful in personality development and experience full knowledge. It sensitises them for pain and pleasure of society.

School and Community Relationship : Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya advocates for strong relationship between School and Society. Institute doesn't mean any system which is going on from long years, the important thing is from how long it is serving the society. This means serving the society is major responsibility of institute by performing duties towards education.

They also believe that human being develops some qualities in themselves and these qualities will help to develop themselves as man. It means they emphasise on 'Perfection' and Perfection should start very beginning. Perfection in own words is "Regular Habits, Truthfulness, Discipline, Working in a proper manner, Making oneself useful and Helping others". Keeping in mind, all these aspects Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya organizes various activities, which help to connect with the society-

- " Senior students take part in medical camp
- " They can help others and should also ask their parents to help others
- " By involving other schools in various activities

Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya also focuses on interaction among teachers, mentors and students etc. that is why Parent-Teacher meet is there periodically (two or three times in a year) for strengthening community engagement and development. Every year programmes are organized for counselling of students, parents and teachers. Institution takes their valuable opinion regarding the development of the students and their requirements.

Conclusion : Our Indian constitution includes educational needs in preamble. It reflects the importance of all educational aspects like contents,

pedagogy, co-curricular activities etc. So that the process of education must be based on democratic values. It will be ensure the equal opportunity in education for individual development of students. Swami Vivekananda visualised the needs of independent India and accordingly he set forth his philosophical thought.

In the light of these philosophical thoughts and principle of Swamiji, researcher has analysed all aspects/dimensions activities i.e. academics, co-curricular activities, extra-curricular activities, school and community relationship of the school. It seems that Ramkrishna Mission Vidyalaya is trying to develop all the qualities and characteristics among the students through different method and different programme, so that they can establish themselves as a good human being and can do something better for our society.

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